

Children's interest and curiosities (2)

Children are engaging parallel play with blocks on the carpet in the block area. They seem interested in stacking blocks to build their own structures.

"When it falls it will be on my tower" - Sara
"Mine is gonna get taller" - Samatha



Showing that they are thinking about collaboration, cause-and-effect, and peer reactions.

How Child learn when they play? (7)

The children demonstrated mathematical skills when they counted the blocks in their towers, showing number recognition and one-to-one correspondence as they carefully added each block. They exhibited scientific understanding by exploring why their towers did not fall, demonstrating concepts such as balance and stability through their building choices. By using blocks to create castles and towers that remained standing, children showed they were beginning to understand basic ideas about gravity and structure. Social and emotional skills were demonstrated when children worked alongside peers, showing cooperation and empathy, especially when discussing what might happen if a friend's tower fell near theirs. Their reflections on why they stopped building showed self-awareness and the ability to express emotions, indicating developing self-regulation and resilience.



The children are learning how to make towers, how high they can build, and how their work looks compared to others. They are building, talking, celebrating their own work and playing together as a group.

"Look at mine, it's huge" - Samatha
"Miss Baker, look at what she is making." - Sara

They are also learning how to make towers taller while still keeping them from falling. At the same time, they use their imagination to turn blocks into castles, showing creativity in their play. Overall, they seem to be thinking about engineering challenges, personal achievement and group interaction.



These observations were supported by the use of open-ended questions such as "Why doesn't your tower fall?" or "What might happen if your friend's tower falls near yours?" which encouraged children to think deeply, explain their ideas and make their learning visible. Through their responses, children demonstrated growing abilities as problem-solvers, creative thinkers and caring friends.



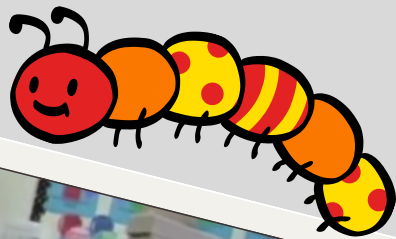
EXTENDING LEARNING THROUGH PLAY(10)



(Robin Suitt, 2015)



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Following the block play activity, the next steps are designed to build upon the children’s interests and reinforce their new skills. By observing their engagement and intentionally planning new opportunities for them to explore and grow, the goal is to help them learn more and more over time. To start, specific moments are observed and documented, such as when children count in special ways or work with friends. New materials are then introduced to the block area, like measuring tapes or connecting pieces, which keep children engaged and encourage them to experiment with new designs. Afterward, a small group reflection is led where things they said or did are revisited, like a tower that did not fall. Finally, these observations are used to inform future curriculum goals, with new activities planned that continue to support their learning in a fun and natural way.

FOUNDATION FOR LEARNING:HOW WE KNOW THEY’RE GROWING (12)

Belonging: Children feel they belong when they join in play, share ideas, and look for encouragement from educators and peers (OMEd, 2014a, p. 28). We saw this when they said things like “Miss Baker, look at what she is making!” and “Nice castle,” showing they felt included and part of the group.

Engagement: Children are engaged learners when they do their best to participate in an inclusive learning environment (OMEd, 2014a, p. 40). In this case, it was seen in their steady focus on building and counting (“One, two three... Twenty one,” “Mine is gonna get taller”), showing they are deeply involved and keep trying even when towers might fall.



Well-Being: A sense of well-being grows as children manage feelings and try new things in a safe space (OMEd, 2014a, p. 35). Their excitement—“It’s not falling!” along with the educator’s gentle reminders—“Be careful, a tornado might blow it down” showed both confidence and self-regulation.

Expression: Easy to see when children talk about their ideas and feelings (“Look at mine! It’s huge “Mine is a castle”, “When it falls it will be on my tower”), letting them show pride, imagination and worries with words and actions. “Children are able to communicate when they learn, understand, and use language for a variety of purposes.” (OMEd, 2014a, p. 42).

How do we know children is learning through playing? (13)



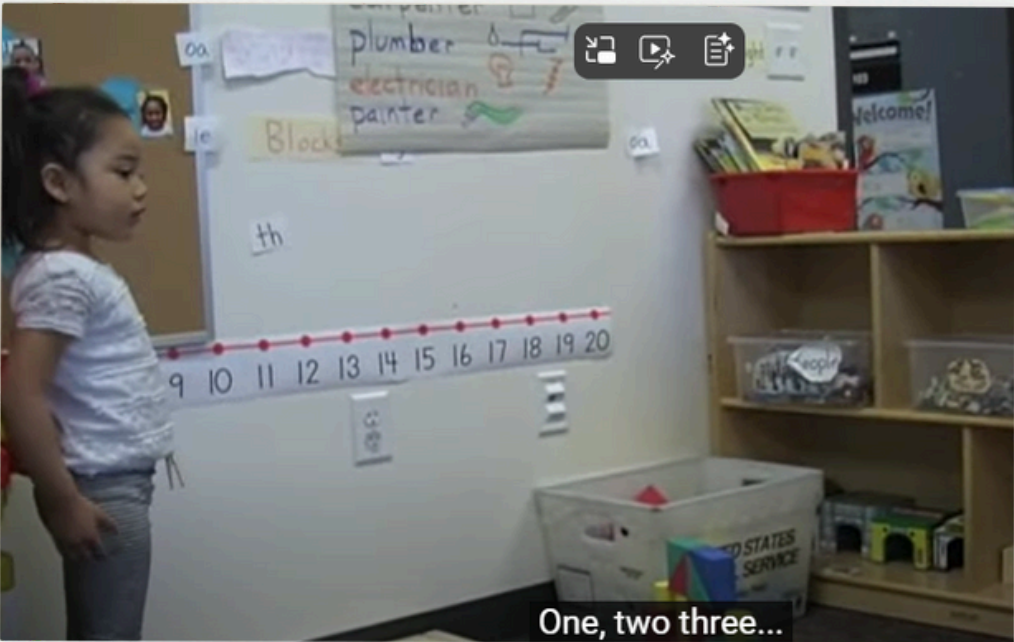
(Robin Suitt, 2015)

"A planned curriculum supports early learning."

Educators create various curriculum help children to grow different domains of development (OMEd, 2014b, p. 8).

=> As educator we have to establish variety of activities that based on children interests and what areas that need opportunities to growth. (OMEd, 2014b, p.8)

Adults playing with children and help them to learn with the activity by asking them questions or interacting with them



(Robin Suitt, 2015)

They demonstrated learning through playing by stacking blocks and counting numbers.

The Principle in E.L.E.C.T said that: "Play is a means to early learning that capitalizes on children's natural curiosity and exuberance" (OMEd, 2014b, p. 9).

Children are actively engaged in trying new things such as testing structure balance. A child is stated confidently "it won't fall down"

what we will do?

- Can children learning when the environment has been changed?
- What skills can children learn when they face challenges while playing?
- We wonder if children can enhance other skills while playing with the curriculum that we plan?

